LOCATION Design Group

SSI PROGRAM

INDIANA STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

The Case for Reinvestment in Indiana Greenfield Site Readiness



Why the state should fund the SSI Program through to site graduation, what it costs to stop now, and how Indiana converts a seven-year lead into an uncatchable one

PREPARED FOR

Office of the President
Indiana Economic Development Corporation
One North Capitol Avenue, Indianapolis, Indiana 46204

PREPARED BY

Victor Leotta, Director, Strategic Sites
Location Design Group, LLC, an ATK Energy Group Company

DATE

November 2026

Companion document: Indiana SSI Program Chronicle, 2018 to 2026. Program facts are documented there with sources; market and competitor figures in this document are cited in the text.

1. The bottom line

Indiana owns the most complete greenfield site inventory of any state in the country, and it cannot yet be fully leveraged. Between 2018 and 2024 IEDC and Indiana's electric utilities invested about $1.39 million to discover, map, locally vet, and rank more than 1,800 greenfield sites across all 92 counties. Of those, 490 are ranked 4.0 or higher on a five-point readiness scale, 141 are ranked 5.0, 70 are potential mega sites, and 85 percent had never appeared in Indiana's public site database. The inventory is the supply side of economic development. It was built at a fraction of what competing states are now spending, and it is the asset beneath the LEAP Research and Innovation District, which IEDC markets as sitting "all on an SSI-certified (Strategic Site Inventory) site" and which now carries $28 billion of announced investment from Eli Lilly and Meta.

The program paused in 2025 at the threshold of the phases that convert inventory into projects: due diligence, landowner control, and graduation to market. Eighteen counties have never been reviewed. Nine of 490 top-ranked sites have Phase II due diligence. None has been carried through Phase III to a purchase option and a public listing. At the same time, the market has moved decisively toward Indiana's advantage. Development-ready site availability is now the number one site elimination factor reported by site selectors, and at least 27 states are funding site readiness in what Area Development calls "a national arms race in site preparation funding." Ohio awarded about $350 million to 11 sites through the All Ohio Future Fund before cutting it in 2025 and funds a further $250 million through JobsOhio; Illinois has committed $500 million, Michigan more than $460 million, Virginia $282 million, and Kentucky $170 million. Those states are paying to build inventories Indiana already has.

The request

Restart IEDC funding of the SSI Program as a three-year Site Graduation Program, cost-shared with the Indiana Power Partners at a budget to be set jointly with IEDC, organized in eight tracks across the SSI phases: complete the statewide review and refresh the inventory; extend Phase I discovery to smaller data center sites and, for the CIRDA region, to inactive facilities and distressed-community areas of opportunity; run Phase II due diligence on the top-ranked sites; advance the first 18 Indiana SSI sites to market under site control on behalf of the regional and county organizations; NAICS-code the full 4.0+ inventory against IEDC's priority sectors so it can feed the SSI: Signals lead generation engine; and keep the SSI Portal live for IEDC, the utilities, and the 92 local economic development organizations that use it.

For scale, Indiana's entire seven-year investment in the program was about $1.39 million, less than one half of one percent of what Ohio awarded through the All Ohio Future Fund before cutting it, and less than the state spent on land for a single LEAP parcel. The program finishes a job Indiana is 80 percent through, on an asset no competing state can replicate in under five years.

1,811	490	18	9	0
greenfield sites identified	ranked 4.0 or higher	counties still unreviewed	sites with Phase II complete	sites graduated to market

#1
site elimination factor in 2026: availability of development-ready sites (61% of site selectors)

76%
of site selectors name development-ready site availability a top factor shaping the industry

+20 pts
year-over-year jump in the weight of site readiness and due diligence status (Area Development, April 2026)

27+
states now fund site readiness, "a national arms race in site preparation funding"

2. Site readiness now decides who wins

The economics of site selection have inverted since the program was commissioned. In 2018 a state competed on incentives and operating costs; a company that chose Indiana could spend 18 to 24 months finding and preparing a site. By 2022 IEDC was telling the State Budget Committee, under the slide heading "speed is new incentive," that deals were being decided in under six months by companies that wanted construction-ready land. By 2026 the constraint had tightened further:

- The Site Selectors Guild and DCI's 2026 State of Site Selection pulse check (March 2026) reports that availability of development-ready sites is cited by 76 percent of consultants as a top factor shaping the industry and is the number one site elimination factor (61 percent). Two thirds of respondents say they have compromised on site or policy quality simply to meet client timelines.
- Area Development's 40th Corporate and 22nd Consultants Survey (April 2026) found that "site readiness and due diligence status" recorded one of the survey's largest year-over-year jumps in importance, 20 points from 2025 to 2026, and that speed to market has become an overriding project goal.
- Hyperscale data center demand is absorbing large powered sites at a rate manufacturing never did. Chief Executive's 2026 survey of location advisors summarizes the result: shovel-ready sites "have been scooped up and developed, taking quality sites off the market." Indiana's own Ginovus projects that by 2027 electricity availability will dominate site selection.
- The consequence for inventories is visible in Virginia, which deployed $282 million through its Business Ready Sites Program, won a string of projects, and in 2026 reports that it faces a shortage of shovel-ready megasites with a single available property of 250 contiguous acres. Winning depletes inventory; a state that stops replenishing falls behind within one project cycle.

Two conclusions follow. First, the scarce asset is no longer capital or incentives but a documented, controllable, powerable site that a company can commit to in weeks. Second, identification is the least expensive and slowest-to-replicate part of readiness: it took Indiana six years to discover and locally vet sites in 92 counties, and that work cannot be reproduced on a short timeline at any funding level. Indiana has already completed it.

3. What Indiana already owns

3.1 The inventory

Asset	Status	Comparable elsewhere
Statewide Phase I inventory	1,811 sites, 235,402 acres, all 92 counties; 1,473 sites not previously in any public listing	No other state has a 100 percent county canvass; Florida (59 to 64 of 67 counties) is the next most complete

Asset	Status	Comparable elsewhere
Locally vetted and ranked inventory	74 counties; 1,385 sites reviewed; 490 at 4.0+; 141 at 5.0	Michigan is only now tiering sites through MI Sites and Michigan Ready Sites; Ohio and Illinois fund nominated sites
Potential mega sites	70 sites of 500 to 5,200 acres in 26 counties	Few states hold a vetted candidate megasite list of this depth; Virginia reports one available 250-acre site
Specialty screens	38 utility-scale solar sites (10,142 MW); 58 statewide hyperscale data center candidates; 38 NIPSCO-area data center candidates	Rare; most states have no systematic data center or solar siting inventory
Phase II due diligence	9 complete, 24 nominated, Candidate Site Indexes for ~35 counties	Comparable states fund dozens per year (Virginia: 45 sites funded 2022 to 2024)
SSI Portal	9 Indiana instances; IEDC, 8 utilities, 107 LEDO/REDO sub-licenses; used for RFI response	No equivalent statewide system of record in neighboring states
Partner network	8 electric utilities, 92 LEDOs, 15 REDOs engaged through workshops and portals since 2020	Unique; Duke Energy has funded its portal every year since 2020

3.2 The proof point: LEAP

The LEAP Research and Innovation District in Boone County is the clearest demonstration that the program works at the state's highest level of ambition. In 2021 Secretary Chambers directed the SSI team to find sites of more than 1,000 acres for hyper-scale technology parks; Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) logged 104.5 hours of LEAP District technical support between June and November 2021, drafted the Mega-Region vision proposal in October 2021, and in March 2022 delivered 69 Technology MegaSite candidates, among them Boone County site 18011-701 at 3,099 acres in the area that became LEAP. IEDC's LEAP brochure and web page describe the district's megasite, advanced manufacturing, mixed-use, and corporate campus settings as sitting "all on an SSI-certified (Strategic Site Inventory) site." Eli Lilly has since committed $18 billion to LEAP and Meta $10 billion. The state's investment in establishing LEAP exceeds $690 million. The SSI work that identified and screened the district cost IEDC a few hundred thousand dollars within the program budgets described in the companion chronicle.

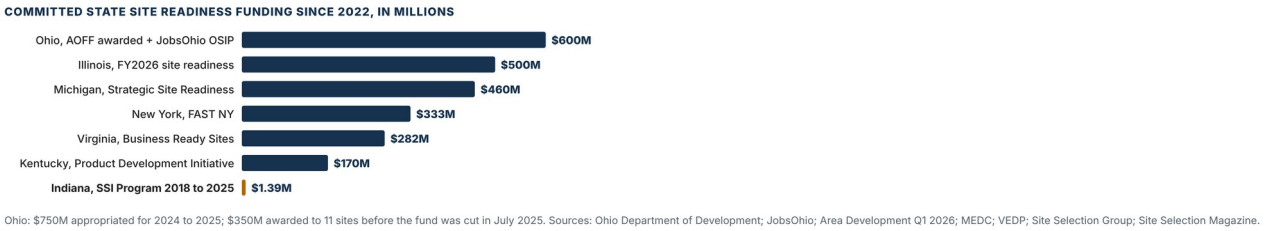
LEAP also shows the limitation of a single flagship. IEDC assembled LEAP by buying land. The remaining 69 mega-site candidates and the 490 sites ranked 4.0 or higher cannot all be bought, and they do not need to be: the SSI Phase III method secures control through landowner purchase options at fair market value, which costs the state nothing but the diligence and the engagement. That is the step that has not been funded.

3.3 Institutional commitment already made

IEDC has repeatedly put its name on the program: a 2020 statewide webinar introducing SSI as a formal site readiness initiative; Indy Fast Friday in 2021 and SSI Program Day at the Indianapolis Motor Speedway in 2022; national releases in November 2022 and May 2023 declaring that Indiana "leads the

nation" in greenfield site identification; the December 2022 State Budget Committee presentation framing strategic sites as the new incentive; and HEA 1001 (2023), which appropriated $150 million for a 2024 to 2025 Site Acquisition Fund "to support the IEDC's strategic sites initiative" (a land-purchase appropriation for IEDC's own Strategic Sites Initiative; nothing in the 2025 budget indicates it continued). The IEDC website today still presents the SSI inventory under Find Sites as "the most comprehensive in the nation," with the dashboard figures quoted in this document. The institutional investment is sunk, public, and still being marketed; what has lapsed is the funding to deliver on it.

4. The arms race Indiana is sitting out



Ohio: $750M appropriated for 2024 to 2025; $350M awarded to 11 sites before the fund was cut in July 2025. Sources: Ohio Department of Development; JobsOhio; Area Development Q1 2026; MEDC; VEDP; Site Selection Group; Site Selection Magazine.

State	Program and funding	What it buys
Ohio	All Ohio Future Fund, $750 million appropriated for 2024 to 2025; about $350 million awarded to 11 sites before the General Assembly cut the fund to a small remainder in the July 2025 budget; JobsOhio Ohio Site Inventory Program, $50 million per year, $250 million for 2025 to 2030	Site preparation grants and loans for speculative sites; awardees must find an end user within five years
Illinois	$500 million FY2026 site readiness initiative (June 2025), including $200 million Site Ready Illinois and Regional Site Readiness; $60 million round in April 2026	Rehabilitation of state-owned sites, regional site readiness grants
Michigan	Strategic Site Readiness Program, more than $460 million in proactive grants in roughly three years; MI Sites and Michigan Ready Sites evaluation programs	Grants and loans to build investment-ready inventory; third-party site validation and tiering
Virginia	Business Ready Sites Program, about $282 million in matching grants 2022 to 2024; reduced to $40 million and $30 million in FY2025 and FY2026	Due diligence through utility extension on sites of 50+ acres; inventory now depleted by wins
Kentucky	Product Development Initiative, $100 million (FY2023 to 2024) plus $70 million (FY2025 to 2026); up to $100 million per project	Due diligence, utility extensions, civil preparation, acquisition
New York	FAST NY, more than $333 million to 41 sites (about 8,800 acres)	Infrastructure to shovel-ready status
Tennessee, South Carolina, Mississippi, Alabama	Site Development Grants ($81 million since 2016), Product Development ($200 million), Site Development Grant Program ($57 million), SEEDS ($20 million)	Site characterization and preparation grants

State	Program and funding	What it buys
Indiana	SSI Program: about $1.39 million total, 2018 to 2025; no appropriation since. A $150 million Site Acquisition Fund (2024 to 2025) funded state land purchase for IEDC's own Strategic Sites Initiative; it is not shown to have continued past 2025	Statewide discovery, vetting, and ranking complete; due diligence and graduation unfunded

Sources: Area Development, What Does Site Readiness Really Mean (Q1 2026); Michigan Economic Development Corporation (March 2026); Ohio Department of Development, All Ohio Future Fund (July 2025); JobsOhio, Ohio Site Inventory Program guidelines (May 2025); Site Selection Group, State of Product Development (December 2025); Virginia Business (2026); Site Selection Magazine (May 2026).

The comparison cuts two ways. Indiana cannot and need not match Ohio or Michigan dollar for dollar; much of that money buys the identification, characterization, and tiering that Indiana already completed, and Ohio's own legislature cut its fund after one round of awards. But the other states are now converting their inventories into controlled, documented, marketable sites, and a site selector working a 2027 project will compare Indiana's unadvanced inventory against Ohio's and Michigan's graduated product. Identification without graduation is a map, not a product. The window in which Indiana's head start is decisive is the next two to three years, before the neighboring programs finish their first cohorts.

5. The cost of not investing

A paused readiness program does not hold its value. The record of the Indiana program itself shows four kinds of loss that compound each year the pause continues.

Inventory decay
Phase I data dates from 2018 to 2021. Ownership, zoning, solar conversion, and data center absorption change conditions every year; rescreening stopped in 2024.

Lost projects
Site readiness is now the first screen. An unadvanced site fails it quietly and the state never learns it lost. One mid-size plant exceeds this whole program's cost.

Partner momentum
Eight utilities and 92 LEDOs organized budgets and calendars around SSI. Phase II slowed when IEDC's budget ran out in July 2024; a cold restart costs more than continuity.

Portal goes dark
IEDC called the SSI Portal "mission critical" for RFI response. Licenses lapsed June 2025; the system of record for 1,811 sites is unavailable to the people who answer prospects.

5.1 Inventory decay

Phase I imagery, parcel, and ownership data were captured between 2018 and 2021. Since then, ownership has changed on an unknown share of 1,811 sites, zoning and land use plans have been amended in dozens of counties, utility-scale solar has absorbed agricultural land of exactly the kind the program identified (the program's own solar screen found 65,433 acres of candidate solar land that overlaps the industrial inventory), and hyperscale data centers have taken the largest powered parcels. Workshop rescreening to update stale counties was underway in 2024 and stopped. Each year without refresh, a larger share of the 4.0+ list becomes unreliable for RFI response, which is the use IEDC's site selection staff make of it weekly.

5.2 Lost projects

Indiana's 2022 to 2024 committed capital investment set three consecutive records ($22.2 billion, $28.7 billion, $38.3 billion through September 2024), driven by projects on large greenfield sites. The next

generation of those projects will be screened on site readiness first. An inventory of ranked but undocumented, uncontrolled sites fails that screen quietly: the project never reaches a formal RFI, and the state never learns it lost. One lost mid-size manufacturing project ($100 million, 200 jobs) represents more state and local revenue than the entire three-year program proposed here. One lost LEAP-scale project represents a thousand times the cost.

5.3 Partner momentum

The utilities and the 92 local economic development organizations organized around the program: Duke Energy has renewed its SSI Portal license every year since 2020, NIPSCO created an SSI Phase II Site Preparedness Grant Program on the program's model, Wabash Valley Power Alliance funded six Phase II studies and an incentive program that rewarded counties for completing workshops, and AES Indiana wrote in 2024 that "the Indiana SSI Program continues to achieve milestones and produce ROI." By October 2024 the utilities had "slowed down on SSI Phase II investments as budgets are being reduced," explicitly following IEDC's lead. A state restart re-catalyzes that cost-share; a continued pause converts a running partnership into a cold restart with partners that have reallocated their budgets.

5.4 The portal goes dark

IEDC's own 2024 budget memo called the SSI Portal a "mission critical resource for IEDC and its LEDOs" that the site selection manager "uses frequently to search for sites for RFI response." IEDC and LEDO access was funded through June 30, 2025 and the utility licenses through the same date (Duke Energy through December 2025). Without renewal the system of record for 1,811 sites, their maps, rankings, ownership data, and due diligence documents is unavailable to the people who respond to prospects.

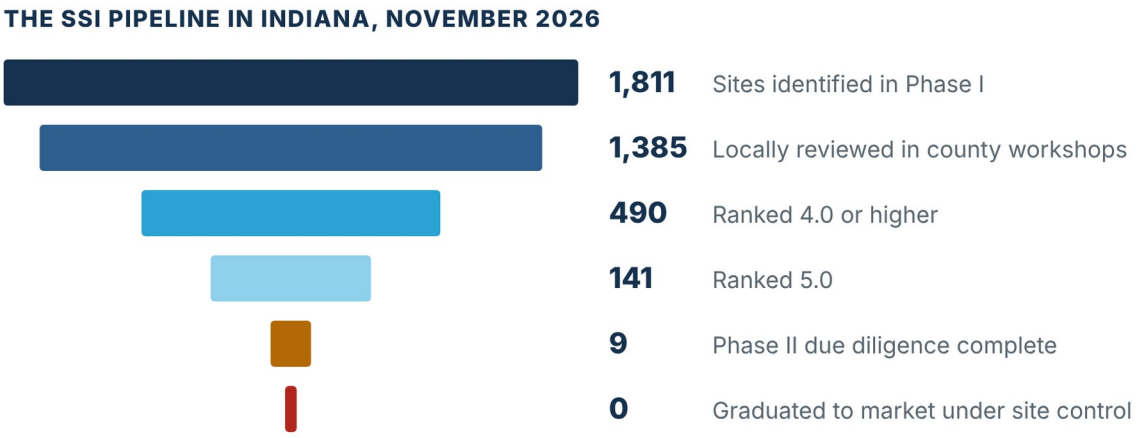
> **Order of magnitude**
>
> Rebuilding the Indiana inventory from scratch in 2029 would cost more than the original program, would take three to five years, and would produce a weaker result because the best sites will have been absorbed. Maintaining and advancing it now costs a small fraction of that; the three-year figure is set in joint scoping against the eight tracks in Section 9.

6. The unfinished job: getting sites across the finish line

The SSI Program is a funnel, and Indiana has funded only its top. The table shows where the inventory stands at each stage and what graduation requires.

Stage	Requirement	Indiana status (Nov 2026)	Gap
Phase I discovery	Statewide suitability modeling and site identification	Complete, 92 of 92 counties, 1,811 sites	Refresh of 2018 to 2021 data
Local review and ranking	Workshop with county officials; rank 1.0 to 5.0	74 of 92 counties; 1,385 sites reviewed; 490 at 4.0+	18 counties; rescreen of early counties

Stage	Requirement	Indiana status (Nov 2026)	Gap
Candidate Site Index	Apolitical 100-point scoring of 4.0+ sites for Phase II nomination	About 35 counties	Remaining counties
Phase II due diligence	Desktop engineering, environmental, utility, and community study with ROM costs; favorable development opinion	9 complete, 24 nominated	Top 36 to 50 sites
Technical marketing	Site Profile and Business Attraction by NAICS Code brochure	17 Site Profiles; 6 Expanded XCEL profiles; few NAICS brochures	Top 100 sites
Phase III site advancement	Landowner engagement, letter of intent, purchase option at fair market value, zoning alignment, conceptual plan	Best practices guidance drafted for IEDC in 2024 (Draft V1, March 2024; not finalized when the program paused) and issued as a clean edition in November 2026; no site advanced	First cohort of 18 sites
Graduation to market	Site under control, documented, published to the state sites and buildings database	None	Entire pipeline



Graduation is defined precisely in the program: a site graduates when it has survived Phase II with a favorable opinion, been visited, secured site control through a real estate purchase option or option pathway at fair market value, achieved zoning alignment, and been documented with a marketing package. Only then is it published to ZoomProspector or its successor. This is also the definition of a qualifying site for LDG's lead generation work. Every one of those steps is desk and relationship work, priced per site at LDG's unit rates in scoping; none requires the state to buy land. Indiana's 141 sites ranked 5.0 are, by definition, sites that readily satisfy all permitting and development conditions; the fastest path to a graduated inventory runs through them.

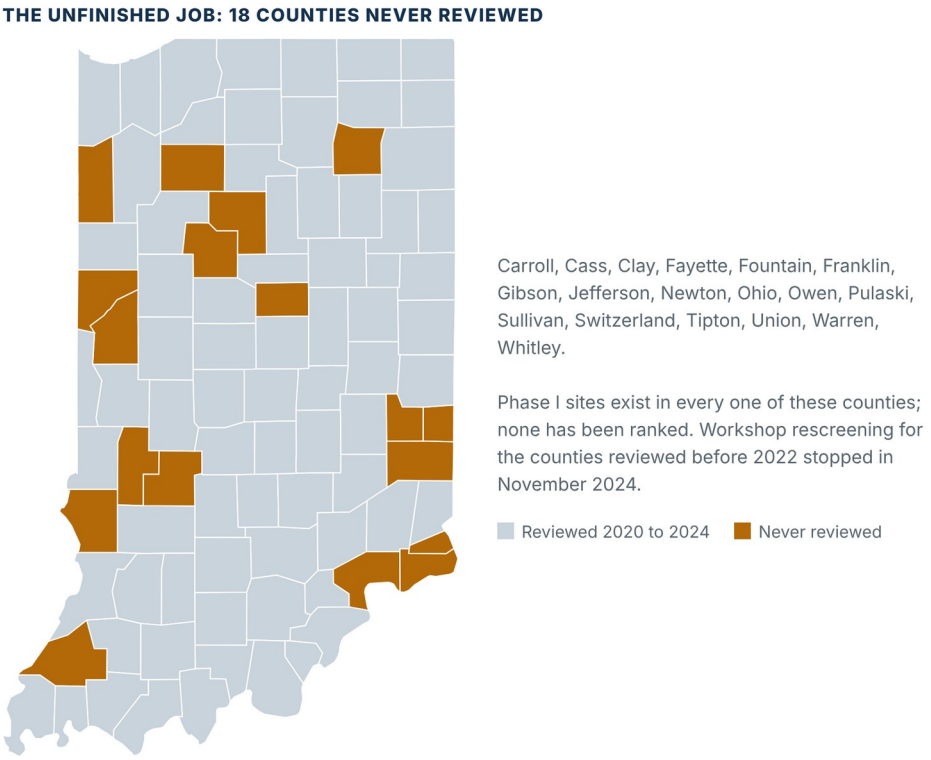


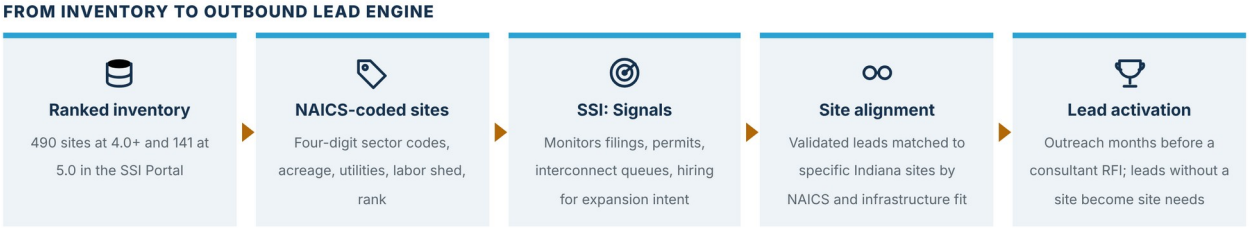
Figure 3. The 18 counties whose Phase I sites have never been reviewed and ranked.

The funnel in numbers

1,811	1,385	490	141	9	0
identified	locally reviewed	ranked 4.0+	ranked 5.0	Phase II complete	graduated

7. The demand side: SSI: Signals and why only Indiana can use it at scale

Since 2025 LDG has been building SSI: Signals, an AI-assisted expansion intelligence system that monitors public data streams (regulatory filings, permits, utility interconnection queues, hiring, capital expenditure disclosures, federal registrations) to detect companies moving toward a location decision, validates those signals with a dual-indicator classifier and a decaying expansion score, and then matches validated pre-leads to specific SSI sites by NAICS code and infrastructure fit (electric capacity, water, acreage, rail, highway, labor shed, zoning). Signals answers who and when; the account-based pursuit protocol that consumes its output answers how. The architecture is a seven-module pipeline (target sector definition, industry growth outlook, company discovery, signal reconnaissance, pre-lead validation, SSI site alignment, lead activation), built so that the site alignment module tests each validated lead against the state's inventory and routes leads without a matching site into a documented site development need rather than discarding them.



Signals is only as good as the site records it matches against. A site can feed the engine when it carries a NAICS-coded land use profile (primary and secondary four-digit codes informed by local targets and tempered by the labor shed), a readiness rank of 4.0 or higher from a local review workshop, developable acreage, utility availability and capacity, transportation assets, and ideally a Phase II report, a Site Profile, and site control. Those are exactly the Phase II, technical marketing, and Phase III outputs that Indiana has not funded. The SSI Portal already supports NAICS-based RFI site searches and carries the attribute schema Signals reads.

The compounding advantage

Every state can buy a lead generation tool. Only a state with a large, ranked, NAICS-coded, controlled site inventory can act on what the tool finds in the time the market now allows. Indiana has 490 ranked sites to code and the partner network to advance them. Signals turns that inventory from a passive list into an outbound engine that matches expanding companies to specific Indiana sites months before a consultant RFI arrives. A state that funds both halves, supply and demand, holds a lead that competitors cannot close by appropriation alone, because the supply half takes years to build.

The Signals-readiness work proposed below is deliberately modest: code the 490 sites ranked 4.0 or higher, produce profiles for the top 100, and expose them to Signals through the portal. LDG carries the cost of the Signals platform itself. IEDC's investment buys the site records that make its inventory matchable.

8. Alignment with the administration's priorities

The current administration has reset IEDC around targeted spending, measurable return, regional strategy, transparency, and growth of existing Indiana business. The SSI Program fits each test better than most of what it replaced.

Priority	How the SSI Program delivers
Targeted, lower-cost economic development	IEDC reports that its incentive cost per job fell 68 percent in 2025 and stands at $16,014 per job in 2026 (IEDC, January and March 2026). Site readiness is the lowest-cost incentive available: a controlled, documented site shortens a company's timeline without a cash grant. The program's total seven-year cost is less than a single mid-size incentive package.
Regional strategic plans	The inventory is already regional: every one of the 92 counties and 15 regional organizations has sites and portal access, and 74 of the 92 counties have a workshop record. Regional plans can be built on an objective site base rather than on nominated properties.

Priority	How the SSI Program delivers
Transparency and objectivity	Sites are mined by suitability model, not nominated; rankings are set in open workshops with county officials; the method was designed, in the words of the 2018 proposal, "to defeat political influence and motivations that compromise site inventory quality." Every site and decision is documented in the portal.
Growing existing Indiana business	Indiana manufacturers that expand need land as much as new entrants do. A ranked county-level inventory serves existing-business expansion requests directly through the LEDOs.
Rural and statewide distribution	Secretary Chambers' stated mission was "to distribute these anchor projects throughout the state." The inventory includes sites in every county, including the 18 rural counties still awaiting review.
Return on LEAP and any future state land purchase	Graduated SSI sites give LEAP-scale prospects alternatives when LEAP is full or unsuitable, and give any future acquisition dollars a vetted pipeline instead of a search.

8.2 IEDC's current priorities and the SSI response

The proposed program is organized around five priorities IEDC has stated or acted on in 2025 and 2026. Each is matched to the SSI phase that answers it and to the tracks in Section 9.

Executive Order 25-45 made the 15 READI regions Indiana's official economic planning regions and asked each to submit a growth plan tied to employment growth, per capita income, and educational attainment; the Central Indiana region's plan came first, and the Governor named CIRDA the first regional steward. Every one of the 15 regions already holds an SSI Portal license and a workshop record for its counties. This program gives each regional plan a vetted, ranked site base to execute on, so that the administration's pillar of powering Indiana's sector strengths regionally has somewhere to put the plant.

Sources: Executive Order 25-45; IEDC, September 4, 2025 and March 17, 2026; IEDC Leadership page (four pillars).

IEDC priority	The need	The SSI response	Tracks
Sites that are held, ready, and marketable	Regional and county economic developers do not have the time or the playbook to take a ranked site to market, and the Phase III method drafted for IEDC in 2024 has never been run on an Indiana site.	Deliver Phase III as a service: LDG carries landowner engagement, site control, zoning alignment, and publication for a first cohort of 18 sites on behalf of the REDOs and LEDOs, and trains the network as it goes.	C
CIRDA and the $1 billion agriculture and life sciences initiative	The Governor designated the Central Indiana Regional Development Authority as the first regional steward of a $1 billion, ten-year tax credit commitment aimed at 100,000 life sciences and agriculture jobs. Growth at that scale needs buildings and land in the right places, and the region's older industrial communities need the growth to reach them.	Three SSI branches aimed at the CIRDA region: Inactive Facility Revitalization inventories and ranks idle commercial and industrial buildings across the ten counties; SSI: Community identifies neighborhood-level areas of opportunity in historically distressed communities; and the ranked greenfield inventory, with nine of the ten CIRDA counties already reviewed, is carried through Phase II and III for sites that fit life sciences and pharmaceutical requirements.	G, H, B, C

IEDC priority	The need	The SSI response	Tracks
Data centers Indiana communities will accept	Indiana ranks third in the Midwest for data center development; 57 proposals were tracked by mid-2026, and local opposition has produced moratoria or bans in 20 counties and defeated 18 proposals. The large-site model is running out of willing land.	Refactor the Data Center Core Suitability Model for sites of roughly 25 to 150 acres on existing substation and fiber capacity, inside the development pattern communities already accept, prioritized in counties without moratoria, and paired with the inactive facility inventory where excess utility capacity makes reuse the fastest path to power.	F, G
High-value target industries: defense, life sciences, pharmaceuticals	IEDC's priority sectors have specific site requirements: water and wastewater capacity and proximity to the research base for life sciences and pharmaceutical manufacturing; secure, buffered sites near the Crane and WestGate defense cluster. A general inventory does not answer a sector-specific RFI by itself.	Code every site ranked 4.0 or higher by NAICS against the priority sectors, produce Site Profiles and NAICS brochures for the top 100 with sector fit called out, weight Phase II nominations toward sector requirements, and expose the coded inventory to SSI: Signals.	B, D
Keep the inventory whole and current	Eighteen counties have never been reviewed, the earliest reviews are six years old, solar and data center absorption has removed sites nobody has re-checked, and the portal IEDC uses for RFI response needs its licenses renewed.	Finish the 18 workshops, rescreen and re-rank the early counties, refresh ownership and zoning statewide, and keep the SSI Portal live for IEDC, the utilities, and the 107 local and regional sub-licenses.	A, E

The funding channel for Tracks G and H: HEA 1406

HEA 1406 (2026) requires IEDC to award $35 million of redevelopment tax credits each fiscal year to regional development authorities for qualified investments in a qualified redevelopment site pursuant to a development plan, and CIRDA now assesses and ranks submitted projects for that allocation. The Inactive Facility Revitalization inventory gives CIRDA an objective, ranked list of qualified redevelopment sites to put behind its development plan, screened for reuse, environmental liability, and reconfiguration before a taxpayer applies. SSI: Community aims the same dollars, and the Lilly Endowment blight redevelopment program's, at the neighborhoods where they will hold. LDG will respond to CIRDA's RFPQ process for this work.

8.3 Power partner support

Indiana Economic Development Corporation
Duke Energy Indiana
Wabash Valley Power Alliance
NIPSCO
Hoosier Energy
AES Indiana
CenterPoint Energy
Indiana Michigan Power
IMPA
92 county LEDOs
15 regional EDOs
Indiana Economic Development Association
Evansville Regional Economic Partnership
Location Design Group, LLC (formerly Leotta Location and Design, LL+D)

The Indiana Power Partners have been the program's co-investors and will be its co-investors again. Duke Energy Indiana originated the program through a Duke Energy Foundation grant in 2018 and has funded its SSI Portal every year since. Wabash Valley Power Alliance, NIPSCO, and Hoosier Energy funded Phase II at $10,000 per site and built grant and incentive programs around the SSI model. CenterPoint, Indiana Michigan Power, IMPA, and AES Indiana license portals and have used the inventory for hyperscale RFIs (Project Osprey, Project Evergreen). The utilities' interest is structural: every graduated site is future load on their systems. LDG proposes that the Phase II and technical marketing tracks be cost-shared with the utilities on the NIPSCO 80/20 or a 50/50 model, which the partners accepted when IEDC was leading. The utilities followed IEDC into the pause; they will follow IEDC out of it.

9. Proposed program: the Indiana SSI Site Graduation Program

The following three-year program defines the scope in eight tracks, grouped by SSI phase. Quantities are sized from the state of the inventory. Costs and cost share are to be determined in joint scoping with IEDC and the Power Partners; LDG will provide unit pricing by track at scoping. The suggested shares follow the program's history, in which IEDC funded discovery and the workshops and the utilities funded Phase II and their own portal licenses.

Track	Scope	Unit basis	Three-year cost	Suggested cost share
Site Discovery (Phase I)				
A. Complete and refresh the inventory	Local Site Review Workshops in the 18 remaining counties with pre-workshop rescreening; rescreen and re-rank the 4.0+ sites in counties reviewed before 2022; update ownership, zoning, and solar and data center absorption statewide	18 workshops with rescreen; statewide refresh of 490 ranked sites	TBD	IEDC
F. Data center model refactored for smaller sites	Rebuild the Data Center Core Suitability Model for sites of roughly 25 to 150 acres with existing substation and fiber proximity, screen all 92 counties, and flag candidates in counties without moratoria; include inactive facilities with excess utility capacity surfaced by Track G	Statewide search, one land use; portal class and site packages	TBD	IEDC, with utility participation
G. Inactive Facility Revitalization for CIRDA	Inventory and rank inactive and underutilized commercial and industrial facilities across the ten CIRDA counties; screen each for highest and best use, environmental liability, and reconfiguration potential, with life sciences and advanced manufacturing reuse as the primary targets	10-county facility inventory and ranked candidate list	TBD	IEDC, with CIRDA

Track	Scope	Unit basis	Three-year cost	Suggested cost share
H. SSI: Community for CIRDA	Neighborhood-level areas of opportunity for redevelopment in the region's historically economically distressed communities, from the convergence of property and community condition data; target parcels and highest and best use per area, aligned to the Catalyze Central Indiana plan	Regional baseline model; areas of opportunity with target parcels	TBD	IEDC, with CIRDA and READI
Due Diligence (Phase II)				
B. Phase II preliminary due diligence	Preliminary due diligence on 36 top-ranked sites (12 per year), selected by Candidate Site Index with IEDC and the utilities, weighted toward sites that fit life sciences, pharmaceutical, and defense requirements	36 sites, 12 per year	TBD	IEDC 50% / utilities 50%
Site Advancement (Phase III)				
C. Site advancement delivered for the REDOs and LEDOs	LDG runs the Phase III playbook on behalf of the regional and county organizations: landowner engagement, letters of intent, purchase options, zoning alignment, conceptual plans, and publication for a first cohort of 18 sites (6 per year), drawn from the 141 sites ranked 5.0 and the Phase II survivors; includes a site advancement training series for the REDO network	18 sites, 6 per year; REDO training	TBD	IEDC, with LEDO participation
Branding and Marketing (Phase V)				
D. Target-industry technical marketing	NAICS coding of all 490 sites ranked 4.0+ against IEDC's priority sectors; Site Profiles and NAICS brochures for the top 100 sites, with defense, life sciences, and pharmaceutical fit called out; portal exposure to SSI: Signals	490 codings; 100 profile and brochure sets	TBD	IEDC 50% / utilities 50%
SSI Portal and management				
E. SSI Portal and program management	IEDC, LEDO/REDO, and utility portal licenses; RFI technical support; program management and quarterly reporting against five metrics	Three years of licenses, support, and management	TBD	IEDC, with utility portal licenses
Total			**TBD**	**To be set in joint scoping**

For scale: Indiana's entire seven-year investment in the program, all clients, was about $1.39 million. Ohio awarded about $350 million to 11 sites through the All Ohio Future Fund before its legislature cut the fund in July 2025, and JobsOhio's site inventory program runs at $50 million a year. The state spent more on land for a single LEAP parcel than the whole SSI Program has cost. Whatever the three-year figure turns out to be, it is the least expensive step in the sequence and the one that unlocks the rest.

What IEDC gets by the end of year three

- 18 Indiana SSI sites graduated: under purchase option at fair market value, zoning-aligned, documented, and published; the first controlled greenfield product cohort in the state's history outside LEAP, advanced on behalf of the REDOs and LEDOs.
- A ranked inventory of inactive and underutilized facilities across the ten CIRDA counties, and neighborhood-level areas of opportunity in the region's distressed communities, feeding the Catalyze Central Indiana plan and the $1 billion life sciences initiative.
- A statewide inventory of smaller data center sites on existing power and fiber, in communities that will host them.
- Phase II due diligence on 45 sites (9 existing plus 36 new), weighted to life sciences, pharmaceutical, and defense requirements, each with rough order of magnitude costs and a development opinion.
- 490 sites NAICS-coded against IEDC's priority sectors and Signals-ready; 100 sites with Site Profiles and NAICS brochures; an outbound lead engine matching expanding companies to specific Indiana sites.
- All 92 counties reviewed and ranked; the inventory refreshed to 2027 conditions; the SSI Portal live for IEDC, eight utilities, and 107 local and regional organizations, with graduated sites flowing to the public database.
- Quarterly reporting in the terms IEDC already publishes: jobs committed and average hourly wage on projects located on SSI sites, measured against the county average wage that Executive Order 25-44 sets as the floor and the 125 percent of county wage in IEDC's guidelines; state incentive dollars per job on those projects, against IEDC's 2026 benchmark of $16,014; and the program's own counts of counties reviewed, Phase II completions, graduated sites, and RFI responses drawing on SSI sites.

Governance and sequencing

1. Months 1 to 3: IEDC and LDG confirm scope, unit pricing, and cost share with the Power Partners; renew portal licenses; scope the CIRDA facility inventory and SSI: Community tracks against the Catalyze Central Indiana plan; publish the Candidate Site Index for all reviewed counties; select the year-one Phase II cohort (12 sites) and Phase III cohort (6 sites from the 5.0 list).
2. Months 3 to 12: complete the 18 remaining workshops; run the refactored data center screen statewide and the CIRDA facility inventory; run year-one Phase II and Phase III; NAICS-code the 490 sites; produce the first 35 profile sets; connect the portal to SSI: Signals.
3. Years two and three: repeat the Phase II and Phase III cohorts, refresh early counties, graduate sites, and report. Graduation of the first sites should occur within 12 to 15 months of restart.

Procurement, conflicts, and reporting

LDG expects this engagement to be procured the way IEDC's commitments after the 2025 forensic review require: competitively above IEDC's bidding threshold, with third-party due diligence on Location Design Group, LEO, LLC (Leotta-Evers Consulting), and ATK Energy Group, a conflict-of-interest screen on the commitment, and Audit and Finance Committee review. Every track is priced at LDG's published unit rates, so IEDC can compute cost per graduated site once scope is set. The inventory, rankings, GIS boundaries, and reports are IEDC's data and will be delivered in open formats whether or not the portal license is renewed. LDG will report quarterly through IEDC's Transparency Portal.

Sources: FTI Consulting forensic review, October 2, 2025; IBJ, April 30, 2025.

10. What this case does not claim

The record should be stated plainly. No Indiana project has yet been traced to a graduated SSI site, because no site has graduated; the one flagship, LEAP, was assembled by state acquisition on SSI-identified ground. The value of the discovery work is demonstrated by LEAP, by the 1,473 sites that did not previously exist in any public listing, and by the use IEDC's own staff make of the inventory for RFI responses. The value of the graduation work is demonstrated by every competing state's program, which spends most of its money on exactly that step. Indiana has funded the identification stage, which takes years. The graduation stage, which takes months per site, is unfunded. This document asks IEDC to fund that stage.

11. Decisions requested

1. Authorize LDG and IEDC's site selection staff to scope the three-year Indiana SSI Site Graduation Program against the eight tracks in Section 9, with unit pricing provided by LDG and the Power Partners invited to confirm cost share, within 60 days.
2. Renew the SSI Portal licenses for IEDC, the LEDO and REDO network, and the utilities immediately, so that the system of record remains available for RFI response during scoping.
3. Support LDG's response to CIRDA's RFPQ process so that the Inactive Facility Revitalization and SSI: Community tracks are scoped against the Catalyze Central Indiana plan adopted in October 2026.
4. Receive a briefing on the inventory, the LEAP precedent, and the SSI: Signals pipeline from LDG at the President's convenience; the companion chronicle provides the full record in advance.

> **Contact**
>
> Victor Leotta, Director, Strategic Sites, Location Design Group, LLC, an ATK Energy Group Company. (225) 281-4202.